

Talking with AI about "what makes a good presentation?" and "what makes a bad presentation?"

ChatGPT answer

Xie: What makes a good presentation? and what makes a bad presentation?

ChatGPT: That's a great question — and one worth mastering, since the quality of a presentation often determines how well your ideas stick with your audience. Let's break it down clearly:

ChatGPT: What Makes a Good Presentation

- Clear Structure
 - Has a beginning, middle, and end: introduction → main points → conclusion.
 - The audience always knows where you are in the talk.
 - Each section flows logically to the next.
- Strong Opening
 - Starts with something that grabs attention — a question, story, or surprising fact.
 - Clearly states the purpose or key message early.
- Focused Message
 - Has one central idea or takeaway.
 - Avoids cramming too much information.
 - Every slide or point supports that core idea.
- Audience Awareness
 - Tailored to the audience's background and interests.
 - Uses examples, language, and visuals they can relate to.
- Engaging Delivery
 - Confident body language: eye contact, open posture, natural gestures.
 - Expressive tone and pacing — not monotone or rushed.
 - Uses pauses effectively to let points sink in.
- Effective Visuals
 - Slides are clean, readable, and not overloaded with text.
 - Use visuals to enhance understanding, not distract.
 - Consistent colors, fonts, and layout.
- Practice and Timing

- Speaker is well-prepared, not reading word-for-word.
 - Finishes within the time limit.
 - Transitions smoothly between topics.
- Strong Ending
 - Summarizes key points.
 - Ends with a memorable conclusion — a call to action, thought-provoking quote, or powerful image.

ChatGPT: What Makes a Bad Presentation

- No Clear Structure
 - Feels random or disconnected.
 - Audience can't tell what the main point is.
- Too Much Information
 - Overloaded slides or too many statistics.
 - Tries to cover everything instead of focusing on essentials.
- Monotone Delivery
 - Little variation in tone, pace, or emotion.
 - Speaker reads directly from slides or notes.
- Poor Visuals
 - Slides packed with text, small fonts, or clashing colors.
 - Distracting animations or irrelevant pictures.
- Lack of Preparation
 - Speaker stumbles, loses place, or mismanages time.
 - Technical issues not tested in advance.
- Disconnection from Audience
 - Doesn't explain context or why it matters.
 - Uses jargon or complex ideas without clarification.
- Weak Opening or Ending
 - Starts with "uh... okay..." or ends abruptly.
 - Leaves no lasting impression.

ChatGPT: Quick Rule of Thumb

A good presentation feels like a story told for the audience.

A bad presentation feels like a report read at the audience.

DeepSeek answer

Xie: What makes a good presentation? and what makes a bad presentation?

DeepSeek: Of course! This is a fantastic question because the difference between a good and bad presentation is often stark and has a huge impact on the audience.

DeepSeek: What Makes a Good Presentation?

A good presentation doesn't just share information; it connects, engages, and inspires the audience. It's a blend of clear content, compelling delivery, and thoughtful design.

1. Content & Structure

- **A Clear Core Message (The Big Idea):** You can summarize the entire presentation in one compelling sentence. The audience leaves knowing exactly what the main point was.
- **A Strong Narrative:** It tells a story. It has a clear beginning (the hook/setup), middle (the evidence/challenge), and end (the resolution/call to action). Stories are memorable and emotionally engaging.
- **Audience-Centric:** It's tailored to the audience's knowledge level, interests, and needs. The presenter answers the audience's unspoken question: "What's in it for me?"
- **Simple and Focused:** It avoids information overload. It distills complex ideas into digestible chunks. Less is more.
- **Logical Flow:** It has a clear structure (e.g., Problem-Solution-Benefit, Past-Present-Future) that guides the audience effortlessly from one point to the next.

2. Delivery & Speaker Presence

- **Authentic Passion:** The speaker believes in what they're saying. Their enthusiasm is contagious and builds credibility.
- **Conversational Tone:** It feels like a dialogue, even if it's a monologue. The speaker makes eye contact, uses natural language, and avoids reading from a script or slides.
- **Effective Body Language:** Open posture, purposeful gestures, and moving around the stage (if possible) to command presence. Smiles and facial expressions that match the content.
- **Masterful Use of Voice:** Varied pace, tone, and volume to create emphasis and maintain interest. Strategic use of pauses to let key points sink in.
- **Well-Practiced, Not Memorized:** The speaker is so familiar with the material that they can deliver it smoothly and adapt to the room's energy without sounding robotic.

3. Visual Aids (e.g., Slides)

- **Visuals Support the Speaker, Not Replace Them:** Slides are a backdrop, not the main event. They use powerful images, minimal text, and clear data visualizations (charts, graphs).

- The "Signal, Not Noise" Principle: The design is clean, uncluttered, and reinforces the message. Every element on a slide has a purpose.
- High-Quality and Consistent: Professional-looking with a consistent color scheme, fonts, and layout.

4. Audience Engagement

- A Strong Opening: Starts with a powerful hook—a surprising statistic, a compelling story, a provocative question—to grab attention immediately.
- Interaction: This could be a question to the audience, a quick poll, or simply reading the room and adjusting accordingly.
- A Powerful Closing: Ends with a clear and memorable call to action or a takeaway that inspires the audience to think, feel, or do something differently. It doesn't just trail off.

DeepSeek: What Makes a Bad Presentation?

A bad presentation is often a painful experience that confuses, bores, or alienates the audience. The common thread is a lack of respect for the audience's time and attention.

1. Content & Structure

- No Clear Point: The audience sits through it and asks, "So what was that all about?" The presentation is a data dump without a central thesis.
- Information Overload: Too many ideas, facts, and figures crammed in without prioritization. This overwhelms and confuses the audience.
- Disorganized and Rambling: There is no logical flow. The speaker jumps between unrelated topics, making it hard to follow.
- Not Adapted to the Audience: It's either too technical for beginners or too simplistic for experts. It fails to connect the topic to the audience's interests.

2. Delivery & Speaker Presence

- The "Slide Reader": The speaker turns their back to the audience and reads the slides verbatim. This is the cardinal sin of presenting.
- Monotone Voice: A flat, unvarying delivery that is a surefire recipe for putting the audience to sleep.
- Distracting Mannerisms: Pacing like a caged tiger, jangling keys, overusing filler words ("um," "ah," "like"), or staring at the floor/ceiling.
- Lack of Passion: The speaker seems bored by their own material, which guarantees the audience will be, too.
- Going Over Time: This shows a fundamental disrespect for the audience's schedule.

3. Visual Aids (e.g., Slides)

- "Death by PowerPoint": Slides are a wall of text in a small font. The slides are the script, making the speaker redundant.
 - Cluttered and Ugly: Busy templates, clashing colors, distracting animations (every word flying in with a "whoosh" sound), and low-resolution clip art.
 - Overly Complex Charts: Graphs and diagrams that are impossible to decipher in the 30 seconds they are on screen.
4. Audience Engagement
- A Weak Opening: Starts with "Hi, my name is..." and an agenda slide, immediately losing the audience's interest.
 - No Connection: The speaker is trapped behind a lectern, avoids eye contact, and treats the presentation as a task to be completed, not an opportunity to connect.
 - No Interaction: The audience is passive listeners, not active participants. They don't ask questions, don't share their thoughts, and don't feel connected to the speaker.
 - An Abrupt or Unmemorable Ending: It just stops, or ends with a weak "That's it, I guess" or an anti-climactic "Any questions?" (without a final summary).

DeepSeek Summary: The Core Difference

Aspect	Good Presentation	Bad Presentation
Goal	To communicate and connect	To broadcast information
Slides	Visual aid for the audience	Teleprompter for the speaker
Speaker's Role	Storyteller and guide	Reader and information dispenser
Audience Feeling	Interested, informed, inspired	Bored, confused, overwhelmed
Structure	Clear narrative journey	Disorganized data dump

DouBao answer

Xie: What makes a good presentation? and what makes a bad presentation?

DouBao: A good presentation effectively delivers core information and resonates with the audience, while a bad one confuses listeners and fails to convey key messages. The difference lies in four core dimensions: goal clarity, content quality, expression style, and visual aids.

DouBao: What Makes a Good Presentation?

A good presentation always centers on the audience’s needs, with the following key features:

1. Clear goal orientation
 - It defines a specific objective (e.g., "let the audience approve the project" or "teach the audience a new skill") and ensures all content serves this goal.

2. Focused and logical content

- It follows a "1 core viewpoint + 3 supporting arguments" structure, avoids irrelevant information, and uses simple examples or data to explain complex points.

3. Engaging expression

- The speaker avoids reading scripts, uses a conversational tone, maintains eye contact with the audience, and inserts 1-2 interactive links (e.g., questions or small polls) to keep attention.

4. Concise visual aids

- Slides use minimal text (no more than 20 words per page), prioritize charts or images over text, and have a unified color scheme (no more than 3 main colors) to avoid distracting the audience.

DouBao: What Makes a Bad Presentation?

A bad presentation often ignores the audience's experience, with the following common problems:

1. Vague goals

- The speaker cannot clearly state the purpose, and the audience leaves without knowing "what they should remember" or "what action to take."

2. Redundant and disorganized content

- Slides are filled with long paragraphs or messy data, the logical order is chaotic (e.g., jumping between topics), and the presentation exceeds the time limit significantly.

3. Dull expression

- The speaker stares at the screen and reads the text aloud, has a flat tone without emotional changes, and does not respond to the audience's confused expressions or questions.

4. Distracting visual aids

- Slides use fancy templates with excessive animations (e.g., flying text), conflicting color combinations (e.g., bright red on yellow), or low-quality images, which divert attention from the content.